ISA 401 - Business Intelligence & Data Viz
18: An Overview of PowerBI

Learning Objectives for Today's Lab:

(A) Review what we learned in **Tableau** on Wednesday.

(B) Constructing simple visualizations using **Power BI**

- Connecting to data using Power BI and understanding its basic terminology
- The ETL Process in Power BI
- Creating simple visualizations with filters in Power BI

1. (0 points) **Warm-up: a Tableau review game (15 minutes).** Open the game address shown on the projector on your lab computer, enter your first name and last initial, and click your seat. The instructions will appear on your screen when the clock starts.

2. (0 points) As an illustrative example of some of the features of **Power BI**, we will be using the BTS flight delay dataset (from: https://www.transtats.bts.gov/DL_SelectFields.aspx?gnoyr_VQ=FGK&QO_fu146_anzr=b0-gvzr). For your convenience, I extracted the data for July–August of 2026, and added the airline abbreviation lookup CSV file. The links to these files are on Canvas under Week 09. As we will go through the demonstration, you are encouraged to note the following:

   (A) How to use the "Get Data" button and the "Query Editor" to **extract** the 2 months of data into Power BI. **Note how Power BI automatically classifies/"guesses" the data types**.

   Some Transformation Steps:

   (B) How to append the data from July–August into one table.

   (C) Import and merge the CSV file to the generated table. **Note how we will also involve fixing the issue that this imported column may not read the column titles.**

   (D) Minor: how to move the "location of the added column" in the "Query Editor"

   (E) Let us make the table more manageable by only selecting:
   - MONTH
   - FL_DATE
   - Airline
   - FL_NUM
   - ORIGIN_CITY_NAME
   - DEST_CITY_NAME
   - DEP_DELAY
   - ARR_DELAY

   (F) Let us ensure that the data types are appropriate and then **load** the data into Power BI.

(G) **Let us create a similar visualization; note that the numbers would be different since the data shown below is not from 2026.**

